

BROOKLINE ADVISORY COMMITTEE
Human Services Subcommittee
Report on FY2019 FY2020 Budget
Veterans' Services

The Human Services Subcommittee held a public hearing on the FY 2020 budget of the Veterans' Services Department on Thursday, February 21, 2019 at 6:00 PM in Town Hall, room 103. The meeting was duly posted.

Attendees included Veterans' Services department head William McGroarty; DICR director Lloyd Gellineau, Ph.D.; assistant town administrator Justin Casanova-Davis; Advisory Committee member Neil Gordon (TMM 1); and Human Services Subcommittee members Ben Birnbaum (Chair), David-Marc Goldstein (TMM 8); Kim Smith (TMM 6); and Claire Stampfer (TMM 5).

BUDGET STATEMENT

The FY2020 budget¹ request represents a negligible \$207 (0.1%) increase over the FY2019 budget, all in the personnel category, due to a steps increase. Personnel costs account for 51.2% of the total budget. There are 2.0 FTEs, including a director, who also serves as emergency preparation coordinator, and a head clerk. About \$27,600 is budgeted for internships for veterans, which pay nearly \$14 per hour for part-time temporary work. The "Other" cost category, which accounts for 41.2% of the total, consists mainly of veterans' benefits (\$144.6K), along with funds (\$18.5K) to commemorate Memorial and Veterans Days. The revenue primarily reflects reimbursement from the state 115 benefit program and fluctuates over time.

PROGRAM COSTS - VETERANS' SERVICES					
CLASS OF EXPENDITURES	ACTUAL FY2018	BUDGET FY2019	REQUEST FY2020	FY20 vs FY19	
				\$ CHANGE	% CHANGE
Personnel	182,913 ²	175,295	175,502	207	0.1%
Services	1,988	2,388	2,388	0	0.0%
Supplies	636	650	650	0	0.0%
Other	117,799	163,535	163,535	0	0.0%
Capital	510	510	510	0	0.0%
TOTAL	303,845	342,378	342,585	207	0.1%
BENEFITS			103,269		
REVENUE	88,311	95,287	95,287	0	0.0%

An examination of departmental budgets over the five-year period from FY2016 to FY2020 shows an \$11,150 (3.4%) increase during this period.

¹ FY2020 Financial Plan, p. IV-104.

² The increased spending is associated with an employee leaving (unused vacation, sick time).

PROGRAM COSTS - VETERANS' SERVICES							
CLASS OF EXPENDITURES	BUDGET FY2016	BUDGET FY2017	BUDGET FY2018	BUDGET FY2019	REQUEST FY2020	FY20 vs FY16	
						\$ Δ	% Δ
Personnel	163,802	167,998	171,260	175,295	175,502	11,700	7.1%
Services	2,538	2,538	1,988	2,388	2,388	-150	-5.9%
Supplies	650	650	650	650	650	0	0.0%
Other	163,935	163,935	163,935	163,535	163,535	-400	-0.2%
Capital	510	510	510	510	510	0	0.0%
TOTAL	331,435	335,631	338,343	342,378	342,585	11,150	3.4%
BENEFITS					103,269		
REVENUE	101,513	110,883	95,287	95,287	95,287		

Discussion

The department, as mandated by state law,³ assists eligible veterans and their families with financial and medical assistance, and receives reimbursement for 75% of approved benefit expenditures. It also helps veterans obtain benefits from the Veterans Administration (VA) and other federal programs. Mr. McGroarty's efforts to serve Brookline's veterans are well known, as is his ability to connect with those experiencing the effects of PTSD. He highlighted some of the issues facing the department, including the desire for veterans to find a job. It has been a particular challenge of late to get authorization for reimbursement of benefits, due to staff changes at the state Department of Veterans' Services. Mr. McGroarty referred to his assistant, Claudia Leone, as a "Brookline hero," who has had considerable success in finding alternative sources of income for veterans. The department also has been able to help veterans navigate the VA system to expedite their receipt of health care. Mr. McGroarty spoke of the benefits to both veterans and the town of the aforementioned internship program, which provides part-time work on a temporary basis for those who are in school or searching for jobs. The department works with 30 to 40 veterans at any given time.

On Veterans Day, there was special mention of WWI veteran Albert Edward "Scotty" Scott, a Brookline newsboy who received a Distinguished Service Cross and was killed in action at the age of 16. Mr. Scott, a graduate of the school formerly known as Devotion, was awarded a posthumous Brookline High School diploma. A widow recently left the office \$100,000, which is currently tied up in probate, but will be placed into a special account once settled. The office would like to purchase a lift-equipped van. A detailed description of FY2019 accomplishments and FY2020 objections appears on pages IV-104 and IV-105 of the FY2020 Financial Plan.

The Subcommittee voted 4-0-0 to approve the FY2020 budget of \$342,585

³ Massachusetts General Laws, M.G.L. ch. 115.

Brookline Advisory Committee
Human Services Subcommittee
Meeting held on 21 February 2019
Town Hall Room 103

The Human Services Subcommittee of the Advisory Committee held a public hearing on the Health and Human Services FY20 budget on 21 February, 2019 at Town Hall.

Attending were Dr. Swannie Jett, Director; Darlene Johnson, Health Dept.; Patricia Maher, Tony Schlaff, Gretchen Stoddard, Cheryl Lefman, Public Health Advisory Council; Ruthann Sneider, TMM-6; Kea Van der Ziel, TMM-15, DICR; subcommittee members Ben Birnbaum (chair), Kim Smith, Claire Stampfer, David-Marc Goldstein.

FY20 Budget:

The FY20 budget is found on pages IV 93-102 of the FY20 Financial Plan. The budget proposal is for \$1,236,042, a decrease of \$6,332, which is a 0.5% decrease from FY19. Personnel remains at 12.62 employees, and increases .5% due to steps. Utilities increases 7.3%, Services 1.7%, and Capital decreases 80.6%. Capital rose last year for the purchase of a new automobile, and for FY20 it is at \$4,185 (\$165 above the FY18 appropriation).

PROGRAM COSTS - DEPARTMENT OF HEALTH AND HUMAN SERVICES					
CLASS OF EXPENDITURES	ACTUAL FY2018	BUDGET FY2019	REQUEST FY2020	FY20 vs FY19	
				\$ CHANGE	% CHANGE
Personnel	908,558	950,450	955,220	4,770	0.5%
Services	206,793	214,362	217,902	3,541	1.7%
Supplies	18,020	15,100	15,100	0	0.0%
Other	4,952	4,120	4,120	0	0.0%
Utilities	38,685	36,823	39,515	2,692	7.3%
Capital	4,020	21,520	4,185	(17,335)	-80.6%
TOTAL	1,181,028	1,242,374	1,236,042	(6,332)	-0.5%
BENEFITS			650,459		
REVENUE	170,816	157,000	157,000	0	0.0%

Budget Discussion:

Most of the discussion was centered on the expansion requests submitted by the Health Director. The following are the 6 expansion requests for funding-

- 1) Substance Abuse-School Health- \$25,000
- 2) Emergency Preparedness Coordinator- \$25,000
- 3) Epidemiologist- \$60,000
- 4) Health Educator-Community Health- \$110,000
- 5) Environmental Health Specialist- \$111,000
- 6) Accreditation- \$77,00

The subject matter of the expansion requests have been discussed in prior years. Dr. Jett pointed out that many communities have larger health departments than Brookline. The Health Department deals with, among other things, tobacco control, lodging house inspections, food establishments, lead paint inspections, mosquito borne diseases such as West Nile and EEE, rubbish enforcement, rabies and TB investigations, snow shovelling compliance, food trucks, emergency management, and also enforces the restaurant tap water on request By-Law and plastic bag By-Law, yet has been effectively level funded for years.

Dr. Jett spoke about the need for a community health assessment and his desire to have the Health Department receive accreditation from the Public Health Accreditation Board.

The subcommittee focused on expansion requests #1 and #3. Given Brookline's entry into legal recreational marijuana, the effect on school age children (as well as adults) is unknown. The number of opioid deaths decreased from 6 in FY17 to 1 in FY18. Having an epidemiologist would also be beneficial to the Town. The subcommittee recognises that it is unlikely that money will be found to fund these, but hopes that some of the revenue the Town expects to get from the new retail marijuana retailers will find its way to the Health Department.

The Health Department will be celebrating National Public Health Week the first week of April.

Budget Vote:

By a vote of 4-0, the subcommittee recommends a Health Department budget of **\$1,236,042**. The subcommittee also voted by a 4-0 vote to recommend an additional \$85,000 for funding expansion requests #1 & 3, for the substance abuse and epidemiologist positions, should funds become available.

BROOKLINE ADVISORY COMMITTEE
Human Services Subcommittee

Report on FY2020 Budget
Department of Diversity, Inclusion and Community Relations

The Human Services Subcommittee held a public hearing on the FY2020 budget of the Office of Diversity, Inclusion and Community Relations (DICR) on Thursday, February 21, 2019 at 5:30 PM in Town Hall, room 103. The meeting was duly posted.

Public hearing attendees included DICR Office Director Lloyd Gellineau, Ph.D.; Assistant Town Administrator Justin Casanova-Davis; DICR Commission member Kea van der Ziel (also a TMM 15); Advisory Committee member Neil Gordon (also a TMM 1); and Human Services Subcommittee members Ben Birnbaum (Chair), David-Marc Goldstein (TMM 8), Kim Smith (TMM 6), and Claire Stampfer (TMM 5).

Budget Statement

The proposed FY2020 budget¹ represents a \$4,494 (1.7%) increase over the FY2019 budget. Personnel increases amount to \$3,894 (1.8%) for Steps pay. Costs for services increase \$600 (1.7%) due to an increase in a cell phone modification. The FY2020 budget includes override funding of \$20,000 that was added to the FY2019 total for diversity and inclusion training for multiple departments. These funds are targeted for staff training on the use of Government Alliance for Racial Equity (GARE) tools, unconscious bias training, standard diversity and inclusion training, and customer service training for front line staff. Costs for other expenditure classes remain unchanged. Total recommended full-time equivalent (FTE) staff positions remain at 2.72, including a director, who also serves at the town's diversity officer and Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA) coordinator; an assistant director; and a part-time community relations specialist, who was hired this year. Handicapped Parking Fine Funds of \$16,501 are applied to offset the salary of \$58,931 for this position.

PROGRAM COSTS - OFFICE OF DIVERSITY, INCLUSION AND COMMUNITY RELATIONS					
CLASS OF EXPENDITURES	ACTUAL FY2018	BUDGET FY2019	REQUEST FY2020	FY20 vs FY19	
				\$ CHANGE	% CHANGE
Personnel	210,239	222,124	226,017	3,894	1.8%
Services	7,642	35,000	35,600	600	1.7%
Supplies	6,843	10,500	10,500	0	0.0%
Other	3,800	3,650	3,650	0	0.0%
Capital	394	875	875	0	0.0%
TOTAL	228,918	272,149	276,642	4,494	1.7%
BENEFITS			84,154		
REVENUE	0	0	0	0	0.0%

¹ FY2020 Financial Plan, p. IV-111.

An examination of departmental budgets over the five-year period from FY2016 to FY2020 shows an overall \$4,494 (1.7%) increase, primarily in the personnel class.

PROGRAM COSTS - OFFICE OF DIVERSITY, INCLUSION AND COMMUNITY RELATIONS							
CLASS OF EXPENDITURES	BUDGET FY2016	BUDGET FY2017	BUDGET FY2018	BUDGET FY2019	REQUEST FY2020	FY20 vs FY16	
						\$ Δ	% Δ
Personnel	168,077	209,027	216,614	222,124	226,017	57,940	34.5%
Services	20,000	20,000	20,000	35,000	35,600	15,600	78.0%
Supplies	9,000	9,000	9,000	10,500	10,500	1,500	16.7%
Other	150	150	150	3,650	3,650	3,500	2333.3%
Capital	850	873	875	875	875	25	2.9%
TOTAL	198,077	239,050	246,639	272,149	276,642	78,565	39.7%
BENEFITS					84,154		
REVENUE					0		

Discussion of Accomplishments and Goals

Dr. Gellineau reviewed the FY2019 activities and accomplishments of DICR, which are described in detail on pp. IV-111 to IV-112 of the FY2020 Financial Plan. DICR staffs such town bodies as the DICR Commission, the Commission on Disability, the Brookline Commission for Women, the Martin Luther King Celebration Committee, the Age Friendly Cities Committee, and the Indigenous People's Day Committee. DICR continued its efforts to bring cultural programs to Brookline, often collaborating with other entities in town to do so. DICR provided staff support and resources to cultural and community events including the Lunar New Year Celebration, the Annual Youth Award event, Roland Hayes events, as well as artist John Wilson events related to the acquisition and dedication of his MLK sculpture. DICR staff has been involved in the Coolidge Corner School renaming process. Staff also provided support and consultation to individuals regarding discrimination and ADA non-compliance, as well as assistance to individuals and families applying for health insurance and government programs.

DICR held an unconscious bias training workshop last fall for community members and town employees and provided a full day of training for department heads and supervisors regarding GARE and race equity tools, including setting of goals. It has been a challenge to involve town employees in these trainings, due to their voluntary nature, and some have left the group for various reasons. The office conducted a civic engagement study and completed an Americans with Disabilities Act (Act) self-assessment. In conjunction with Human Resources, staff started attending job fairs to recruit a more diverse employee applicant pool. DICR also held pop-up events to promote civic engagement and the town's visibility. DICR is working to determine and promote diversity of town vendors and contractors.

The director recently earned credentials as a certified diversity executive (CDE) from the Society for Diversity, and the associate director is in the process of doing so, which will enable them to conduct in-house training.

In addition to continuing the aforementioned cultural and community events and collaborating on the development of new ones, DICR objectives for FY2020 include:

- In conjunction with Human Resources, monitor diversity and inclusion employment trends, as well as devise strategies to encourage diversity in the town workforce, boards, and commissions.
- Coordinate at least three job fair events
- Meet with each department to develop diversity and inclusion plans.
- Have the town develop a data system to track the diversity of town's vendors and contractors.
- Have three or more Town Departments reviewed by GARE.

Dr. Gellineau indicated that to date in FY2019 there have been four discriminatory conduct complaints: one against the town and three against businesses. In addition, there have been 24 ADA complaints and consultations.

Recommendation

The Subcommittee voted 4-0-0 to recommend approval of the proposed FY2020 DICR budget of \$276,642.